

Success Metrics

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Introduction

This whitepaper introduces a comprehensive yet practical framework for defining and measuring success criteria in technical pilots of the You.com platform. **Success criteria should serve as a mutual framework**—a shared set of benchmarks that both You.com and its organizational partners use to evaluate the solution's fit and value within unique business contexts. This collaborative approach fosters transparency and builds mutual trust in the partnership, creating a foundation where both parties align on expectations and outcomes. By establishing clear, specific, and measurable criteria from the outset, all stakeholders can objectively assess outcomes, evaluate business impact, and make informed decisions about next steps.

To support this, the whitepaper provides actionable guidance on designing surveys that rigorously evaluate pilot outcomes. It emphasizes aligning survey design with well-defined success criteria and leveraging both quantitative methods, such as Likert scales, and qualitative feedback to ensure robust, data-driven evaluation. The goal is empower practitioners to generate accurate insights and maximize the value of technical pilots, accelerating successful AI platform adoption organizationally.

Background & Problem Statement

Organizations implementing AI platforms like You.com face present challenges in effectively evaluating technical pilots due to success criteria that often remain vague, subjective, and disconnected from empirical measurement. This problem stems from three intersecting factors: the **vast array of potential AI use cases** across organizational functions with no clear starting point for value assessment, the relative **novelty** of these technologies within many business contexts, and the diverse needs of **multiple stakeholders** with varying priorities.

These challenges in defining success criteria directly impact measurement capabilities and outcomes. Because success criteria are often vague, measuring success can be equally challenging. Qualitative data does not lend itself to quantitative analysis. User feedback and surveys should be

strategically structured to enable robust statistical analysis, providing clear and objective evaluation of potential transformative value. These results can then be directly translated into tangible business metrics and ROI calculations.

Frameworks for Success Criteria

Successful AI platform pilots must be anchored in clearly defined success criteria that directly connect to both organizational objectives and specific use cases. The most effective success criteria bridge technical capabilities with business outcomes, creating a comprehensive evaluation framework that satisfies all stakeholders. Well-structured criteria should encompass multiple dimensions including:

- Core usage (such as user adoption rates),
- Workflow efficiency improvements (measured as time reduction percentages)
- User satisfaction

These should all be expressed as quantifiable targets that support objective assessment and decision-making.

Industry-standard frameworks provide valuable scaffolding for developing robust success criteria. The SMART framework ensures criteria are:

- **Specific:** e.g., "Reduce workflow completion time 15% for document summarization tasks."
- **Measurable:** Quantifiable through adoption rates and satisfaction scores
- **Achievable:** Realistic and testable within pilot constraints
- **Relevant:** Aligned with business process objectives
- **Time-bound:** Evaluated within the defined pilot period

To illustrate how these frameworks can be applied in practice, consider this example of how vague criteria can be transformed: "Time saved per participant per day $\geq$ 15 min." A more effective approach identifies specific workflows (email drafting, document summarization, research),

establishes baseline completion times, and measures percentage reductions ($\geq 15\%$) across these distinct activities. This granularity enables more precise evaluation and creates data points that can be directly incorporated into ROI calculations.

A multi-dimensional approach to success criteria captures the full impact of AI implementation across technical performance, user experience, and business value. Critically, when efficiency metrics involve improvements or reductions, establishing clear baselines before implementation is essential. Breaking down general goals into workflow-specific measurements not only provides more actionable insights but also enables organizations to identify which AI applications deliver the greatest value. This targeted approach allows for more meaningful comparisons, supports data-driven decision-making about platform expansion, and creates metrics that can be effectively scaled to project organization-wide impact. The resulting framework ensures pilot evaluations move beyond technical validation to demonstrate meaningful business value, providing a solid foundation for investment decisions and organizational alignment.

Survey Development for Gathering Statistics

Effective survey instruments should directly extend established success criteria, aligning measurement with organizational objectives. Design surveys for completion within 2-5 minutes to prevent drop-off and diminished data quality. Incorporate both quantitative metrics (time saved, relevance ratings) and qualitative elements to enable statistical analysis for ROI calculations while providing contextual understanding of user experiences.

Select participants who represent intended impact areas, focusing on business functions and workflows where the AI platform will deliver significant value. This targeted approach ensures findings address core objectives and provide meaningful ROI insights. Establish a clear survey timeline with baseline measurements before implementation and follow-up data at predetermined intervals (mid-pilot and conclusion) to track progression.

Design questions using validated measurement approaches that transform vague, binary questions ("I liked using the platform") into specific assessments using Likert scales across multiple dimensions (see appendix A for examples). This creates comprehensive satisfaction scores with specific evaluative facets. Complement structured questions with strategic free-form fields to capture contextual feedback. This integrated approach transforms survey data into a powerful decision support tool balancing statistical measurement with nuanced user experiences.

Reporting and ROI Calculations

Translate survey data into compelling ROI narratives by converting usage statistics into business value. Calculate immediate impact by multiplying interactions by efficiency gains and applying appropriate cost factors.

Example: A pilot with 20 participants generating 800+ interactions over a standard 4-week trial at 2 hours saved per user/week and 80%+ relevancy scores translates to approximately 1,600 hours saved. Additional productivity value can be directly expressed in monetary terms based on average hourly rate.

These baseline calculations enable scaled projections across different adoption scenarios (500, 1000, and 2000 users) presented through compelling visuals including comparative tables, growth charts, and FTE equivalents. These quantifiable metrics build business cases that resonate with various stakeholders: ROI calculations for finance leaders, efficiency metrics for department heads, and strategic alignment for executive leadership.

By framing results in terms of business outcomes rather than technical capabilities, these metrics bridge the gap between pilot performance and enterprise value, transforming a technology evaluation into a compelling business transformation narrative that accelerates adoption decisions.

Conclusion & Recommendations

The journey from AI platform exploration to successful enterprise adoption depends critically on how organizations approach technical pilots. By establishing specific, measurable success criteria that align directly with business objectives, organizations create a solid foundation for meaningful evaluation. Survey instruments should mirror these criteria, combining quantitative metrics with qualitative feedback to support evidence-based decision-making.

We recommend organizations adopt four key practices to maximize their assessment of value within an AI platform technical pilot:

1. **Define SMART success criteria** that reflect intended impact areas and establish clear baselines for measurement
2. **Design focused surveys** that collect aligned quantitative and qualitative data within 5-10 minutes completion time
3. **Collect data systematically** at strategic intervals with representative stakeholder participation
4. **Translate results into ROI narratives** that demonstrate business value in terms meaningful to decision-makers

By following this structured approach, organizations can transform technical pilots from subjective experiments into strategic initiatives that deliver measurable value and accelerate successful AI platform adoption.

Appendix A: SMART Survey Question Examples

Usage Patterns & Efficiency

How many queries do you submit to the AI platform per day on average?

- 1-3 queries
- 3-5 queries
- 5-10 queries
- 10+ queries

What percentage of your queries receive satisfactory responses on the first attempt?

- 90-100%
- 70-89%
- 50-69%
- 30-49%
- Less than 30%

How much time does the AI platform save you per task compared to traditional methods?

- 1-2 hours a day
- 2-3 hours a day
- 3-5 hours a day
- 5+ hours a day

Response Quality & Accuracy

Rate the factual accuracy of the AI platform's responses (1-10 Likert scale)

1 = Frequently inaccurate, 10 = Consistently accurate

How often do you need to fact-check or verify the AI's responses?

- Never
- Rarely (10% of responses)

- Sometimes (25% of responses)
- Often (50% of responses)
- Always (100%+ of responses)

Rate how well the AI keeps the context of a conversation thread with multiple follow-ups (1-10 scale)

1 = Poor context retention, 10 = Excellent context retention

Feature Utilization & Functionality

Which AI models/engines have you used during your trial period? (Select all that apply)

- ChatGPT
- Claude
- Gemini
- Llama
- Minstral
- Auto
- Custom/Specialized models

How frequently do you use the document upload feature?

- Daily
- Several times per week
- Weekly
- Rarely
- Never

Rate the platform's ability to handle your specific file formats (1-10 scale)

1 = Cannot handle my files, 10 = Handles all file types perfectly

User Experience & Interface

How intuitive is the platform's navigation and layout? (1-10 scale)

1 = Very confusing, 10 = Extremely intuitive

Rate the platform's response speed/latency (1-10 scale)

1 = Unacceptably slow, 10 = Fast

How satisfied are you with the platform's mobile/cross-device experience? (1-10 scale)

1 = Very poor, 10 = Excellent across all devices

Business Impact & ROI

Which work functions have benefited from the AI platform? (Select all that apply)

- Research and analysis
- Content creation/writing
- Data processing
- Customer support
- Strategic planning
- Technical problem-solving

How has the AI platform improved your work productivity during the trial period?

- Dramatically improved (50%+ productivity increase)
- Significantly improved (25-49% productivity increase)
- Moderately improved (10-24% productivity increase)
- Slightly improved (5-9% productivity increase)
- No noticeable improvement

How likely are you to recommend this AI platform to colleagues? (Net Promoter Score 0-10)

0 = Would not recommend, 10 = Would definitely recommend

How likely are you to continue using this platform after the trial period? (1-10 scale)

1 = Very unlikely, 10 = Definitely will continue

Comparative Analysis

Compared to other AI tools you've used, how does this platform rank? (1-10 scale)

1 = Significantly worse, 10 = Significantly better

What are some of your reasons for choosing this platform over alternatives? (Select all that apply)

- Superior response quality
- Accuracy
- Ability to control/customize sources
- Better user interface
- More model options
- Integration capabilities
- Cost effectiveness
- Unique features

Appendix B: Suggested Survey

How much time do you typically save per week with your use of [you.com](#)?

- 4+ hours
- 3-4 hours
- 2-3 hours
- 1-2 hours
- 1 hour or less

How relevant are [you.com](#)'s responses to your questions?

Likert scale 1-10 with 1 being not at all relevant and 10 being very relevant

How helpful are [you.com](#)'s responses to your questions?

Likert scale 1-10 with 1 being not at all helpful and 10 being very helpful

How easy is it to use the [you.com](#) interface?

Likert scale 1-10 with 1 being very difficult and 10 being very easy

The [you.com](#) platform made getting information faster.

Likert scale 1-10 with 1 being very disagree and 10 being strongly agree

The [you.com](#) platform made my work easier.

Likert scale 1-10 with 1 being very disagree and 10 being strongly agree

I was able to select from a variety of LLM options to respond to my prompt?

Yes/No

I was able to upload a file or use a link to support the information I needed to provide in the [you.com](#) platform,

Yes/No

So far, what has been the most impactful use case for you in the [you.com](#) platform?

Free-form response

Any other feedback you want to offer?

Free-form response

*Consider brief demographic/contextual questions if respondent segmentation is valuable